

Aws Abdulfattah

Founding Engineer • I rebuild broken products into businesses

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Founding engineer. I take products that are failing or unbuilt and make them into businesses.

At **Cardiyiq** (10% equity) I inherited an agency-built app that only ran over a VPN, with no CI/CD, no caching, and cash-only payments. I rebuilt backend, dashboard and mobile in production — then argued the **business model** itself from a confusing entry-pass system into points, which is what let the company stop being a gym app and become a sports network: **150+ venues, 6 cities, 1,200 subscribers, ~\$53K GMV in 7 months**. I hired and lead the team of five.

Before that: **Tasdid** and **Tasdid+** at Qi Card, Iraq's largest fintech — national payment infrastructure serving **1M+ users**. And **HAWSR**, a company I built out of my own master's thesis to **\$60K revenue** before shutting it down.

Twelve years building systems people depend on; the last five in software. Nine before that as an architect, including post-conflict housing reconstruction for UNOPS in Anbar. Technology without a business model is just an app.

SKILLS

What I'm for — Taking a failing or unbuilt product to something a business can stand on. Including the parts that aren't code.

0→1 and 1→10 Business-model design Hiring & team building Partnerships & sponsorship Production rebuilds

Payments

Card tokenization Idempotent endpoints Reconciliation Webhooks SuperQi / Alipay APIs

Languages

TypeScript JavaScript Python SQL

Frontend & Mobile

React Svelte / SvelteKit Next.js React Native Tailwind

Backend & Data

Node.js Express Bun Prisma REST design

Infrastructure

Linux / VPS Docker GitHub Actions Dokploy Read replicas & failover

Distributed systems

BullMQ RabbitMQ Idempotency Retries & DLQ Rate limiting

AI

OpenAI API Gemini Prompt engineering Coding agents Token/cost optimization

EXPERIENCE

Cardiyiq — Founding Engineer & Technical Lead

September 2025 — Present • concurrent, equity
Baghdad, Iraq

- Owner of the product's technical fate. Took over an agency-built app days after a failed launch: **only ran over a VPN** (DNS/CDN), no caching, no CI/CD, English-only dashboard, cash-only payments. Rebuilt backend, dashboard and mobile **in production**.
- Pushed the change that mattered most: **replaced the entry-pass business model with points**. That single decision let Cardiyiq stop being a gym-subscription app and become a sports network — pools, padel, equestrian — **150+ venues, 6 cities**, expanding.
- **1,200 active subscribers • 10K+ installs • 12K+ check-ins • ~\$53K (70M IQD) GMV in 7 months**, tracking toward ~\$76K and 2,000 subscribers.
- Introduced card and wallet payments (Wayl, Tasdid pay-by-Qi) and killed manual cash handling. Wayl called it the best payment integration they had seen, by success rate.
- Hired and lead a team of 5 — backend, frontend, mobile, UI/UX, QA. I run hiring, budget and performance. 30 mobile releases in 6 months at **99.9% uptime**.
- Used relationships built over a decade to **secure the sponsor** covering a major share of costs for Cardiyiq's largest 2026 padel event. Engineering was never the whole job.
- Stack: Flutter, React, TypeScript, MySQL, Docker, GitHub Actions, Dokploy, Linode, Laravel (inherited).

Qi Card — Senior Software Engineer — Billing

November 2024 — Present
Baghdad, Iraq

- Billing team at Iraq's largest fintech. I build inside **SuperQi**, Qi Card's super-app, on an Alipay-based mini-app runtime. Promoted to Senior in March 2026.
- Built **Tasdid**, the pay-with-Qi service other companies integrate to accept Qi Card payments — and **Tasdid+**, the bill-payment mini-app on top of it: **1M+ users, ~500K transactions/month**. I now integrate that rail into other people's products as a consultant.
- Built **Jabi+**, a merchant mini-app for 1–10 person businesses: transactions, statements, payroll, supplier payments, Excel export. And **e-Psule**, trilingual regional billing for the Kurdistan Region.
- Took a peer-to-peer invoicing flow through **Central Bank of Iraq** review and won it, then hardened it after internal security review (OTP verification, payer identity hidden at initiation).
- 5+ mini-apps shipped, including a white-label invoicing SaaS other businesses spin up under their own branding.
- Mentor juniors and university students through the Qi Card–AUIB programme.

Independent — Payments Integration Consultant

2025 — Present
Iraq · Remote

- Retained by 5 startups to integrate Iraq's payment rails — **Tasdid (pay-by-Qi)** and **Wayl** — into mobile and web products. Clients include Orivo, 3aljni and Skincare by Self.
- I built the Tasdid service itself, so integrations land first-time-right: correct redirect/webview handling, idempotency, webhook reconciliation, and checkout flows that don't lose users mid-payment.

Sifrtas — Software Engineer

September 2023 — July 2024
Remote

- One of four engineers on a weekly meal-ordering platform; took over both backend and frontend.
- Cut hosting costs 4× — **\$200/month to \$50/month** — through infrastructure and deployment changes.
- Built the deployment pipeline, and a Telegram bot serving as notification system and delivery tracker, removing manual coordination from daily operations.

HAWSR — Founder

July 2020 — August 2023
Baghdad, Iraq

- Turned my own master's thesis into a company. Built a 3D property-visualisation web platform (Three.js, React Three Fiber, React, Tailwind) to **~\$60K in revenue**.
- Automated the Autodesk Revit → web delivery pipeline with Dynamo and Python, removing manual model preparation.
- R&D: a pipeline converting 360° captures (Insta360 SDK, Python) into interactive **3D Gaussian Splatting** scenes for real-estate and photography use.
- Wound down. The market was too small, funding ran out, and splatting quality at that time did not scale. **1st Prize, The Station Foundation Incubator; Most Innovative Startup Founder, CS50x Baghdad**. Presented HAWSR on stage to an audience of 1,000+.

UNOPS — BIM Consultant — Anbar Reconstruction

August 2022 — August 2023
Anbar, Iraq

- Managed reconstruction of housing for families displaced by the ISIS conflict in Anbar — contractors, budgets, delivery schedules and BIM coordination under field conditions. Wrote code nights and weekends throughout, and joined my first startup engineering role before the contract ended.

SELECTED WORK

NotifyX — Open-source Notification Infrastructure · github.com/awsdang/notifyx

2025 — Present · Open source

Multi-channel notification platform: FCM, APNS, HMS and Web Push behind one API, with plug-and-play SDKs for web, Flutter and React Native. Backend API, worker and scheduler in **Node.js, BullMQ, Redis and PostgreSQL (Prisma)** — asynchronous job processing, scheduling, retries and queue orchestration. Load-tested with k6 at **~150 messages/sec per worker**. React admin dashboard for delivery operations.

Sadeek — AI Product Content Automation

2024 — 2025

A Telegram bot that turns a merchant's bad phone photo into sellable product content: description, pricing estimate, background removal, lighting enhancement and AI-generated try-on — then publishes to a Next.js storefront.

GPT and Gemini for generation, pricing and moderation; **n8n** for workflow orchestration; Node.js and PostgreSQL underneath. The engineering problems were **cost per request, image-pipeline quality, and keeping a stateful bot alive at scale** — not the models.

Asheerty — Family Tree → Fine-Art Print

2026 — Present · Live on iOS & Android

Mobile app for building a family or tribal tree, which we then print and ship as a framed fine-art painting. Digital product, physical fulfilment.

React Native, React dashboard, Bun + Express, AI APIs. Built largely with coding agents (Claude Code, Codex) — shipped to both app stores solo. Early: under 100 users.

EDUCATION

Turing College —Certificate, AI Engineering

October 2025 — 2026

Completed. Capstone: Maaahr, an AI interview-practice platform, later extended to live voice.

University of Technology —B.Sc., Architectural Engineering

October 2012 — July 2017

University of Ljubljana —Erasmus Exchange, MSc Information Management (coursework & thesis)

October 2020 — October 2021

Coursework and thesis completed remotely; degree not conferred (visa denied during COVID-19). The thesis was commercialized as **HAWSR**.

AWARDS, CERTIFICATIONS, COMMUNITY & LANGUAGES

1st Prize — Incubator Program The Station Foundation · 2022	AI Engineering Turing College · 2026	The Station Hackathon 2023 — Present	Arabic Native
Most Innovative Startup Founder in Baghdad CS50x Baghdad · 2022	Machine Learning for Inverse Graphics & AI MIT · March 2024	Startup Weekend Baghdad 2017 — 2023	English Professional — IELTS 7.5–8
	Python — AI & Machine Learning 10K Arab AI Developers Initiative · January 2024	Toastmasters International 2020 — 2021	Dutch Beginner
	Three.js Journey Bruno Simon · July 2022	Qi Card × AUIB 2025 — Present	